

Shadow Breathing

“Warrior of Breathing” — the Idol Form

“Do not fear the dark. Breathe it in. Let it fill you — and then there is nothing left in the dark to fear you.”

— a whisper from the idol

The Warrior of Shadow Breathing is the strangest and most secretive of the forms — a discipline touched by something older than any monastery. Its practitioners breathe in the gloom itself, drawing the dark into their lungs until it answers to them. When they ignite their breath, their blade runs violet-black, the shadows fold around them like a cloak, and they see clearly in darkness that blinds everyone else.

Few teach this form openly, for it walks close to powers most monks are warned away from. Those who carry it often carry a question they cannot yet answer — why the dark heeds them, where the breath truly comes from, and what waits at the end of the path they have started down. Mastered well, it makes a warrior into something the night itself seems to bend around.

Shadow Breathing Features

Monk Level	Feature
3rd	Shadow Breathing
6th	First Form: Umbral Slash
11th	Advanced Shadow Breathing
17th	Third Form: Eclipse

Level 3 — Shadow Breathing

Monk Weapons. For you, a katana (and any sword you take up as your signature blade) counts as a **Monk weapon**. You can use your Martial Arts die with it, make Bonus Action Unarmed Strikes alongside it, and use all this subclass’s features through it.

Eyes of the Idol. The idol’s gift never fully leaves you. You have **Darkvision out to 60 feet** (if you already have Darkvision, its range increases by 60 feet), and you have **Advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks** at all times — the gloom favors you.

Igniting the Breath. When you roll Initiative, you can spend 1 ki point to ignite your breath for the rest of the combat (until the combat ends, you have the Incapacitated condition, or you choose to end it as a Free Action). Your weapon glows violet-black and deals an extra **2 necrotic damage** on every hit.

One With the Gloom. While your breath is ignited, the dark wraps around you: you have **Half Cover (+2 AC) against ranged attacks** (anywhere, not just in shadow), and you can **see normally in magical Darkness** (the dark is yours).

Level 6 — First Form: Umbral Slash

First Form: Umbral Slash. As a **Bonus Action**, you can spend **1 ki point** to teleport up to **15 feet** to an unoccupied space next to a creature you can see, engulf that creature in a **10-foot Cube of magical Darkness**, and make one weapon attack against it. On a hit, the attack deals **3d8 + your Dexterity modifier** necrotic damage, and you make the attack with **Advantage** (you strike from a dark only you can see through). The Darkness lasts until the end of your next turn.

This replaces your Flurry of Blows as your Bonus Action for the turn. The Darkness also blinds anything inside it that cannot see through magical dark — place it with care.

Level 11 — Advanced Shadow Breathing

Advanced Breathing. Your ignited breath drinks deeper of the dark. While it is active you gain all its original benefits, and now also: once per turn, when you hit a creature that **cannot see you** (for example, a creature in Darkness, or one with the Blinded condition), the attack deals an extra **2d6 necrotic damage**.

Sharpened Gloom. The damage of your *First Form: Umbral Slash* increases to **5d10 + your Dexterity modifier**.

The dark you make is a weapon as much as a cloak — blind a foe, then strike where it cannot follow.

Level 17 — Third Form: Eclipse

Third Form: Eclipse. As a **Bonus Action**, you can spend **3 ki points** to vanish into the gloom and strike from everywhere at once. Create a **20-foot Cube of magical Darkness** centered on yourself (you see through it normally), then teleport to and make one weapon attack against **up to three different creatures** within it. Each attack deals **5d10 + your Dexterity modifier** necrotic damage on a hit, made with **Advantage**. **Bonus:** each creature hit is **Blinded** until the end of your next turn, and you remain **heavily obscured** (effectively unseen) to everyone but yourself until the Darkness ends at the end of your next turn.

AT LEVEL 7, STABBY HAS: Shadow Breathing (Level 3 stance) + First Form: Umbral Slash (Level 6, 3d8+DEX). The Level 11 and 17 features unlock as he grows.